

# Find out more

IF YOU ARE NOW A FAN of Shakespeare, here are some ways in which you can gain a greater appreciation of his works and his life. The Bard's plays continue to be popular in the theater world, so you will never have to search far to find a Shakespearean performance. Many libraries also hold videos of stage performances or film adaptations. A trip to Stratford-upon-Avon is a must for any true devotee, as is an afternoon at London's reconstructed Globe theater. However, the best way of all to understand Shakespeare is to read his works aloud with a group of friends.

## THEATER FESTIVALS

Theater communities often commemorate the work of Shakespeare with a festival in his honor. Such festivals celebrate his life by staging his plays and also holding interactive workshops and talks for fans to attend. This production of *The Merchant of Venice* was part of a Canadian Shakespeare festival.



The Great Hall  
in the Folger  
Shakespeare  
Library



## EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES

Most public libraries will have a lending section dedicated to the works of Shakespeare. If you want to study in more depth, you can find out if there are any specialist Shakespeare resource centers near you. The Folger Library in Washington D.C., holds thousands of rare and historic editions of Shakespeare's works in hundreds of different languages.

## USEFUL WEB SITES

- Find out about the history of Shakespeare's hometown and what can be seen there today:  
[www.stratford-upon-avon.co.uk](http://www.stratford-upon-avon.co.uk)
- Great resource guide with history, timeline, quotations, and essays on all things Shakespeare:  
[www.absoluteshakespeare.com](http://www.absoluteshakespeare.com)
- Fun site with opinion polls and an automated poetry machine based on Shakespeare's vocabulary!  
[www.shakespeare.com](http://www.shakespeare.com)
- Read the complete works of the Bard online.  
[www.bartleby.com/70/](http://www.bartleby.com/70/)

*Water reed from  
Norfolk was used  
to thatch the roof  
of the new Globe.*

*The gates show the flora  
and fauna of Shakespeare,  
and each creature or  
plant illustrates a line  
from a play.*

## THE GLOBE

The Globe theater in London, England, was built as a replica of the original Globe theater for which Shakespeare worked. The theater, which opened in 1997, is an open-air playhouse and requires the audience to stand in the main auditorium. The Globe aims to recreate the kind of interactive relationship that Shakespeare's original audiences would have had with his work. The season runs from May to September when the weather is good.

